IT265 Game Design Treatment

Student submission

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Worksheet link

https://courses.ethereallab.app/assignment/v4/IT265-001-F2026/it265-game-design-treatment/tjb72

Grading link

https://courses.ethereallab.app/assignment/v4/IT265-001-F2026/it265-game-design-treatment/grading/tjb72

AI disclosure: Completed; 1 entry; 0 declared AI use; 1 declared no AI use; policy v1

Game Concept And Mechanics

Working title

Response prompt

Give a working title and explain why it fits your game. Mention alternatives only if useful.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The title choice is connected to the game's concept. (up to -0.25 points)

Submitted response

The game's working title is "Planetarium Imperium." It signifies how players will be battling for supreme control over planets.

Setting and premise

Response prompt

Describe the game's setting, theme, and the player's role or characters. Explain the story or situation that frames play; a game without a story can describe its premise.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The setting, theme, and player role form an understandable premise. (up to -0.5 points)

Submitted response

The game's setting is the galaxy. The theme is science-fiction space conquest and interplanetary warfare. The players' roles ar conquerors who take it upon themselves to battle for the right to rule planets.

Player goals

Response prompt

Explain what the player is trying to achieve, what stands in the way, and how success, failure, or the end of play is determined.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The goal, challenge, and end conditions let a reader understand the intended outcome of play. (up to -0.5 points)

Submitted response

The goal is to conquer the most solar systems by the end of the game. Players compete as rival space empires, fighting across planets in each solar system. To conquer a solar system, a player must win at least three of the five planetary battles. The mai challenge is defeating the opponent while managing energy, health, and available cards. Each player must use their cards strategically to reduce their opponent's health from 100 HP to 0. Players must also adapt to the unique effects of each planet, b stronger decks, and use new cards and Augments to improve their chances of winning future battles. Random card selections planet effects add unpredictability, requiring players to adjust their strategies throughout the game. A player wins an individual by reducing their opponent's HP to zero. The winner claims that planet, while the losing player does not. After five planetary ba the player who has conquered at least three planets wins the solar system. The game continues with new solar systems until th are no more planets left to conquer. The player who has conquered the most solar systems at the end of the game wins.

Core gameplay loop

Response prompt

Describe a typical turn or repeated interaction: what the player chooses or does and how the result changes the next decision. Game state means the current situation, such as positions, resources, or score.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The repeated player actions and resulting state changes explain how the core gameplay loop works. (up to -0.5 points)

Submitted response

A typical turn begins with each player drawing five cards from their deck. The players then decide which cards to played based their effects, energy costs, and the opponent's remaining health. Each player has three energy per turn at a baseline, so they n carefully choose how to spend their energy to deal damage, defend themselves, or gain an advantage. Players can also use on Augment per turn to temporarily enhance one of their played cards. At the end of the turn, all cards, whether played or not, are returned to the player's deck, which is then shuffled. The players repeat this process, using their cards strategically to reduce th opponent's health from 100 HP to zero. As the opponent's health decreases, players must adjust their decisions and strategies to win the battle. Once a battle ends, both players receive a new card to improve their decks, chosen from three randomly reve options. The winner also chooses the next planet from three randomly revealed options. This means that the outcome of each affects the choices and challenges in the next one. The cycle of drawing cards, spending energy, fighting, and improving decks continues until all planets are conquered.

First physical prototype

Response prompt

Describe your planned physical prototype, including its play area and pieces or materials, such as a board, cards, tokens, dice, or a score sheet. Explain what the pieces represent and how a player uses them to try the core gameplay loop. A finished prototype or playtest result is not required here.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The plan identifies the prototype's pieces or materials and explains how they support its core gameplay loop. (up to -0.25 points)

Submitted response

The prototype will be made of four decks which support the card game. There will be a planet deck, representing the planets an their unique effects. There will be an Augment deck, representing the Augments and their effects. There will be an upgrade dec representing the major permanent upgrades gained after each solar system. And finally, there will be a "playable" deck which contains the game's main playable cards.

Audience And Access

Target audience

Response prompt

Identify the intended players, their relevant interests and play habits, and why the concept and play experience should appeal to them.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The intended audience and relevant interests or play habits are identified. (up to -0.5 points)
- The proposed game experience is connected to that audience with a reasoned explanation. (up to -0.5 points)

Submitted response

The intended audience is players who enjoy competitive strategy games, collectible or deck-building card games, and science- themes. It is designed primarily for players who enjoy head-to-head competition, tactical decision-making, and games that rewa planning and adapting to changing situations. These players may also enjoy space exploration, futuristic technology, and the id building an empire. The game should appeal to this audience because it combines strategic card play with a larger progression system. Players must think carefully about which cards to use, how to manage their limited energy, and how to build their deck prepare for future battles. The randomized cards, planet effects, and upgrades keep each playthrough unpredictable and encou players to experiment with different strategies. Additionally, the competition to conquer entire solar systems gives players a lon

objective beyond simply winning individual battles. The creates an experience that rewards both tactical skill and long-term stra planning.

Accessibility and inclusivity

Response prompt

Explain concrete ways players with different abilities can perceive, understand, and use the physical game, and how those choices can carry into the later digital version without losing the intended gameplay.

Requirements and potential deductions

- Specific accessibility and inclusion considerations are tied to actual game interactions. (up to -0.5 points)
- The response explains how the proposed choices preserve play and can inform the digital version. (up to -0.5 points)

Submitted response

Since the game uses multiple types of cards, color-coding can help players distinguish between cards categories. Each card ty also has its own written label so that players with color blindness or visual impairments can recognize them. High-contrast colo larger text, and clear card layouts also make important information, such as energy costs, card effects, and planet abilities, eas read. Larger cards also make handling components easier for players with limited dexterity. Since the game is turn-based, play not need to make decisions quickly, giving them time to read cards and plan their actions. These accessibility choices could ca over into the digital version. Cards could have scalable text, clear labels, high-contrast options, and screen-reader-compatible descriptions. Players could also use keyboard or controller inputs instead of relying entirely on a mouse or touchscreen. Visual indicators could communicate health, energy, card costs, and planet effects without depending on color alone. Optional remind and tooltips could explain card effects and game rules when needed. These changes would make the game more accessible w changing its core mechanics. Players would still draw cards, manage energy, use Augments, fight planetary battles, and comp conquer solar systems. The goal is to make the information and controls easier to perceive and use while preserving the game strategy, competition, and decision-making.

USP, Pitch And Visuals

Unique selling points (USP)

Response prompt

Identify your game's unique selling points (USP): the distinctive design choices that give intended players a reason to choose it. Explain these through a relevant comparison with an existing game.

Requirements and potential deductions

- Concrete design differences explain the game's appeal to intended players compared with a relevant existing game. (up to -1 points)

Submitted response

One of the main unique selling points is that my game combines competitive deckbuilding with a larger system of planetary con A relevant comparison is Star Realms, another science-fiction-themed competitive deck-building card game. In the core game, players build their decks by acquiring new ships and bases, then use them to attack their opponent until their Authority reaches While my game shares the concept of building a deck and fighting an opponent, it adds several distinctive mechanics that mak gameplay different. Instead of each battle being a separate fight to determine the winner, battles are connected through a large objective: conquering an entire solar system. Each solar system consists of five planetary battles, and winning a battle allows t winner to choose the next planet from three randomly revealed options. This makes each victory meaningful because it influen challenges and opportunities in the next battle. Another unique feature is the progression system. After every battle, both playe choose a new card from three randomly revealed options, allowing them to continuously develop their decks and experiment w different combinations. Augments are chosen from three randomly revealed options after the completion of each solar system. can be applied to one played card each turn, creating additional strategic choices. Both players also receive a major permanen upgrade after one conquers a solar system. These features give players a reason to think beyond winning individual battles. Th must consider how their decisions, deck improvements, and planetary victories will affect the rest of the game. The combinatio interconnected battles, player-controlled planet selection, temporary card enhancements, and long-term progression gives my its own identity. It should appeal particularly to players who enjoy competitive deck-building games but want a longer strategic experience in which every battle matters.

Concept pitch

Response prompt

Write a concise pitch that brings together your concept, intended audience, player experience, and strongest USP. Summarize your earlier answers rather than repeating their full details.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The pitch clearly communicates the concept, audience, intended experience, and strongest USP. (up to -1 points)

Submitted response

Planetarium Imperium is a competitive science-fiction deck-building card game where two rival space empires battle for control galaxy. Designed for players who enjoy strategy, card games, and science fiction, the game combines tactical, turb-based com with long-term progression and empire building. Players fight across five planetary battles to conquer each solar system, using limited energy, and temporary Augments to defeat their opponent. After every battle, players improve their decks with new card creating opportunities to develop different strategies. Each victory also influences the next battle, as the winner chooses which to fight on next. What makes this game unique is that individual battles are connected and consequential. Rather than simply w one fight, players must think ahead, adapt their decks, and make strategic decisions that affect their chances of conquering an solar system. The result is a competitive experience where every battle contributes to a larger struggle for galactic domination.

First sketch or storyboard panel

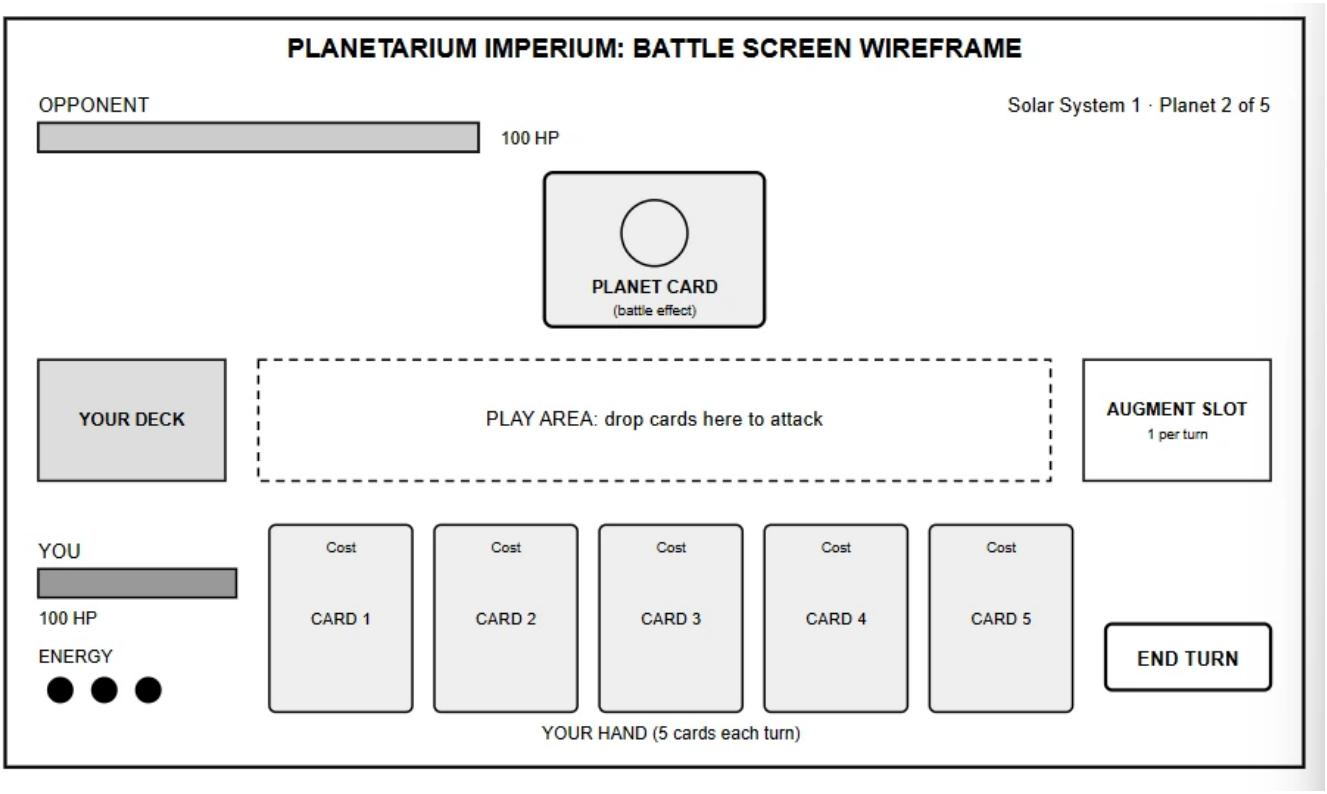
Image evidence prompt

Upload one readable sketch or storyboard image showing the game's concept, style, space, or player interaction. Add a caption explaining what it represents.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The sketch or storyboard panel makes one important part of the game concept understandable. (up to -0.5 points)
- The image and caption connect its visual choices to the game's theme or player experience. (up to -0.5 points)

Caption: Wireframe of a Planetarium Imperium battle screen. The planet card at the top center shows the effect that applies to this fight. Both players' HP bars sit at either side, and each starts at 100. At the bottom is the player's 5-card hand, with three energy dots for the turn's budget. Cards are dragged into the play area to attack, and one Augment can be added to a played card each turn. The layout puts the planet being fought over at the center of the screen, so every battle feels tied to the larger fight for the solar system. The deck, hand, and Augment slot are kept in separate zones, which addresses my playtest feedback that players got confused about which cards belonged to which deck.



Second sketch or storyboard panel

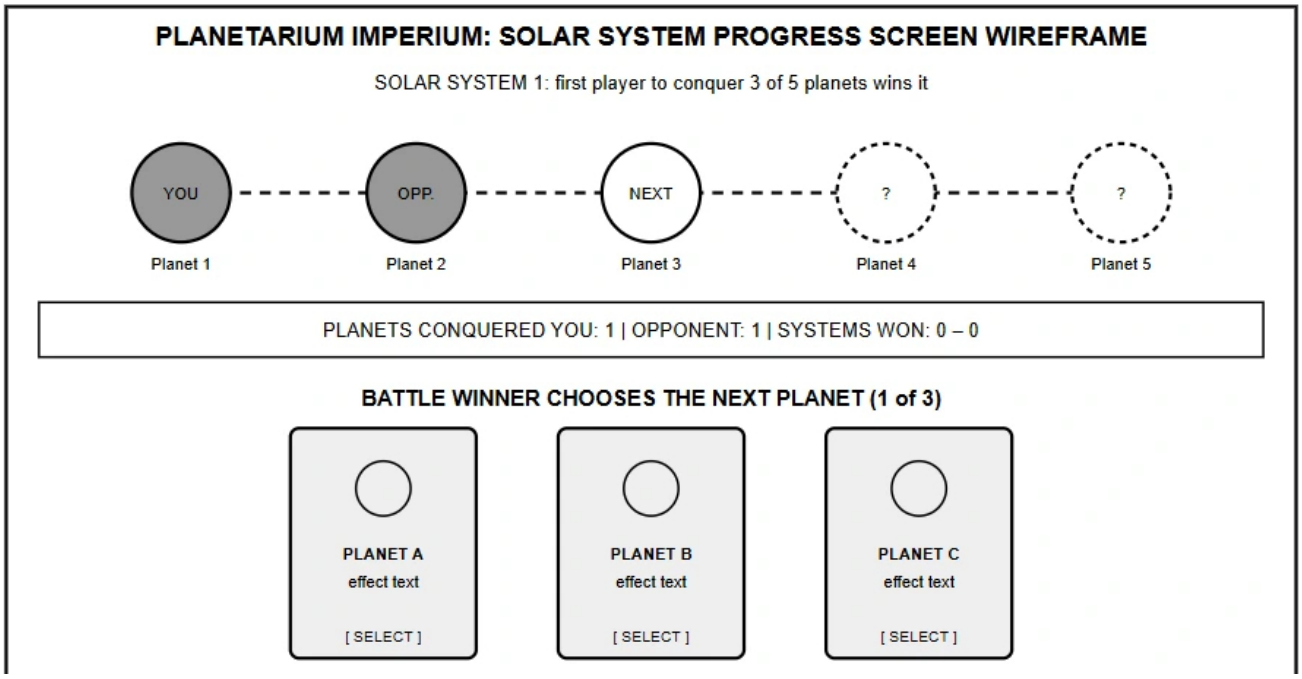
Image evidence prompt

Upload one different readable sketch or storyboard image showing another part of the game's concept, style, space, or player interaction. Add a caption explaining what it represents.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The second sketch or storyboard panel adds distinct information about the game concept. (up to -0.5 points)
- The image and caption connect its visual choices to the game's theme or player experience. (up to -0.5 points)

Caption: Wireframe of the solar system progress screen. The five circles along the top are the five planets of one solar system, filled in gray once a player has conquered them. A score bar shows planets conquered and systems won. Below that, the winner of the last battle chooses the next planet from three face-up options, each with a visible effect. The path of planets makes it clear that every battle is one step in a larger campaign, and choosing your next battlefield rewards the winner. This screen shows the long-term arc, where each battle has consequences for the rest of the run.



External Feedback

Feedback 1

Response prompt

Record feedback from person 1, using a different person for each feedback task and preferably someone in the intended audience. Give initials or a first name and their relationship to you, summarize a specific observation about the concept, mechanics, or style, and explain a revision or next test prompted by it.

Requirements and potential deductions

- The feedback provider and their relationship are identified without private contact details. (up to -0.2 points)
- The feedback reports a specific observation about the concept, mechanics, or style. (up to -0.3 points)
- A revision or next test follows from this feedback. (up to -0.2 points)

Submitted response

My friend Reneka, while playtesting, kept getting confused about which cards to which deck. The game has several piles (the playable deck, the planet deck, Augments, and the major upgrade deck), and she often couldn't tell what type a card was witho asking me. I had to stop and remind her several times, which slowed the game down and made it frustrating. I color-coded eac of card so players can tell a card's type at a glance. I also added a label to each card. I also plan to keep the decks in separate on the play screen. I will run another playtest with a new person and see if they can tell the card types apart without any remind from me. I'll count how many times they need help. My goal is zero reminders.

Feedback 2

Response prompt

Record feedback from person 2, using a different person for each feedback task and preferably someone in the intended audience. Give initials or a first name and their relationship to you, summarize a specific observation about the concept, mechanics, or

style, and explain a revision or next test prompted by it.

Requirements and potential deductions

- A different feedback provider and their relationship are identified without private contact details. (up to -0.2 points)
- The feedback reports a specific observation about the concept, mechanics, or style. (up to -0.3 points)
- A revision or next test follows from this feedback. (up to -0.2 points)

Submitted response

In an earlier version of the game, Augments were permanent upgrades attached to specific cards. My friend Aimee pointed out this was hard to manage in a physical game, because all the cards are shuffled back into the deck at the end of every turn. Kee each Augment with the card it belonged to was difficult. She found this confusing and said it interrupted the flow of play. I chan Augments into their own card pool. Now, once per turn, a player picks one Augment from their growing collection and applies it card they play. The effect lasts only for that turn, but the Augment stays in the player's collection permanently. This removes th to track which Augment is attached to which card, and it made play more creative because players can choose different combi each turn. I will playtest the new Augment system with another person and watch whether they can use Augments correctly wit help. I'll also check whether the "one Augment per turn" limit feels balanced. If it feels too strong or weak, I'll adjust how many Augments players are offered after each solar system.

Feedback 3

Response prompt

Record feedback from person 3, using a different person for each feedback task and preferably someone in the intended audience. Give initials or a first name and their relationship to you, summarize a specific observation about the concept, mechanics, or style, and explain a revision or next test prompted by it.

Requirements and potential deductions

- A third distinct feedback provider and their relationship are identified without private contact details. (up to -0.1 points)
- The feedback reports a specific observation about the concept, mechanics, or style. (up to -0.3 points)
- A revision or next test follows from this feedback. (up to -0.2 points)

Submitted response

Alan, my dad, said that battles felt too slow at the start because everyone only has 5 cards in their starting deck, so they drew t same cards for a while. I changed the game to have a 10-card starting deck instead. I will next test whether that makes the gar more fun and varied.